

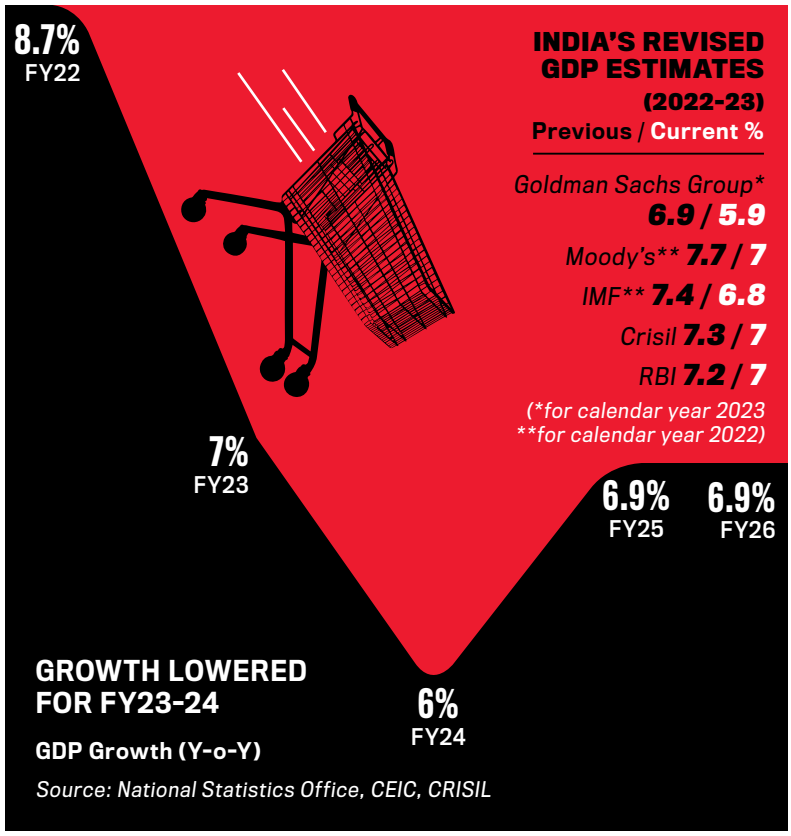
pride (hence the political sine qua non for current CM Shinde, who leads a breakaway faction that's claiming the legacy of the late Bal Thackeray). But it also puts the BJP, which is in power in both states, in a tricky spot. So when Bommai, on November 22, said he was considering resolutions passed by gram panchayats in Jat taluk to accede to Karnataka, it was Maharashtra deputy chief minister Devendra Fadnavis who responded that the resolution was a decade old and that "no village in Maharashtra will go to Karnataka".

The Supreme Court has so far dwelt only on the basic technical questions. Karnataka's argument, says a senior lawyer, is that the suit is not maintainable—via Article 3 of the Constitution, which confers on Parliament the power to form new states or alter boundaries. Maharashtra, meanwhile, is invoking Article 131, which gives the Supreme Court jurisdiction in disputes between states.

Meanwhile, Maharashtra ministers Chandrakant Patil (BJP) and Shambhuraj Desai (Shiv Sena-Shinde faction) plan to visit Belagavi on December 3 on the invitation of MES activists in the city. To this, Kannada activists like Ashok Chandargi are urging Bommai to dispatch a similar tit-for-tat delegation to Jat. The border, clearly, is set to see more shelling. ■

ECONOMY

WHAT IS HURTING INDIA'S GROWTH



Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

By M.G. Arun

A host of global agencies as well as the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) have revised India's growth estimates for the year 2022-23—and beyond. All of them underline the fact that the economy continues to be vulnerable to a slew of external shocks as well as high inflation and rising interest rates that will dampen demand on the domestic front. These call for an urgent need to boost demand through better job creation, while pumping up government spending on infrastructure projects, as the Centre moves closer to its annual budget presentation on February 1.

Goldman Sachs Group Inc, for instance, sees India's economic growth slowing next year, citing a hit to consumer demand from higher borrowing costs and fading benefits from the pandemic reopening. Lowering its growth forecast in a report, it now says India's gross domestic product (GDP) is expected to expand only by 5.9 per cent in the calendar year 2023—its earlier estimate was 6.9 per cent. Meanwhile, ratings firm Crisil has trimmed its GDP growth forecast for 2022-23 to 7 per cent from 7.3 per cent. Crisil also expects India's GDP growth to slow to 6 per cent in fiscal 2024, down from the 6.5 per cent estimated previously, as global growth is expected to fall